



Sleep with peas

For people who find it really comfortable sleeping on their stomachs, try sleeping with a pea taped there. Read more: <http://dgit.in/stmchpea>



Try before you buy

Worried about the size of the clothing you buy online? Why not try it first. Read more: <http://dgit.in/trybfrubuy>

Feature

magazine, in which case, stop reading now and go dunk your head in the toilet! (*Despite our best efforts he's just too lazy to invest in anything, or even save tax in any way!*)

For anyone else though, hacking into your account will not really yield a hacker too much; a burglar, however, can probably make off with much more from the average middle class Indian's home! Perhaps that's why you're more likely to yell "Chor! Chor!" in your life than "Hacker! Hacker!"

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India is a diverse country, and for almost everyone, English is a foreign language. Well, OK, for those of you insulted by that statement, it's a second language for most... However, most (if not all) services you access are English-based. Taking the most popular first language as an example – Hindi – we often find that people use a lot of 'Hinglish' for their usernames, and thus it stands to reason that we do the same for our passwords. This means that normal dictionary attacks on our accounts are just rendered useless!

Then there's the problem of Hinglish inconsistency. "My dog Tommy" could translate to "MyKuttaTommy" as a password, or, "MeraKuttaTommy" or "TommyMereKutte". And that's just Hindi...if it's a mixture of more languages, that makes it even more complex. This makes it a lot harder for anyone trying to hack you from outside India. Even simple dictionary word passwords in India are way more complicated thanks to the many languages. A person from Chennai, living in Maharashtra, might use a Tamil-Maharashtrian-Hindi mix for his password that would flummox anyone trying to guess it, yet be super simple for the person to remember.

Aplenty

India is the land of aplenty. Well, not bandwidth, but everything else – people, especially! The reason we bring this up is because one way a hacker can get access to your email address, for example, is by trying to answer your security question. You know, those questions that usually involve people, or pets. Stuff like "What was your School Principal's surname?", or "What is your neighbour's pet's name?", etc.

Thanks to our abundance of people, every such question is just more complex to answer. Not so much abroad. For instance, if you looked up Facebook, found someone in the US who listed their email address as public information. You could, theoretically, dig through their public information to try and find ways into their account. say they've listed their address, or checked in "At Home" on some co-ordinates. Now you know where they stay. You can take a leap of faith here and assume they've lived here all their lives (especially if they're under 20 or over 60). If their secret question is something like the ones we mentioned above, you could do a quick search for schools close by (if the school name is not public info already on their Facebook profile), assume the closest public school to be the one they went to, look up who was principal of the school when they might have been in school (usually the school website itself will tell you this as they boast about their history), and you have answer #1.

You could also search for check-ins by others at the same location, maybe find a neighbour, or maybe their Facebook photos themselves will have their neighbours tagged, and then a click through to the neighbour's profile will usually have pictures of their pet. Usually helpfully captioned for a hacker; such as, "Look what *Hercules* did today when we were out!" And they thought no one would find out their neighbour's pet's name was Hercules!

The same applies to silly security questions such as: Mother's maiden name, Name of your first school, Where was your wedding reception held, What is your pet's name, Your father's date of birth, etc. Most of this is easily hackable thanks to the data we share online ourselves!

It's not as easy if you're Indian though. People abroad have two or three neighbours max, whereas depending on what city you live in, here in India, we can have anything from three to 300 neighbours! Although you may have listed your school name in your profile, sometimes even if you have, the school doesn't have a web site still, or some Pakistani hacker has already hacked it and now the site is useless as an information source. You can't use check-ins, because there are too many, or too few. Even something as simple as your mother's maiden name is complex in India because of the sheer amount of names to choose from, and you would never add your mum on Facebook anyway, so no hacker is finding out that way...



PC, Laptop
Tablet, Mobile

सुरक्षा



92.72.70.70.50
98.22.88.25.62

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